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Project Management 1.1

Introduction to Project Management

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this session, you will be able to:
  - Define a project
  - State why projects are used
  - Discuss the differences between process and project
  - Identify the need for projects in organisations
  - Give examples of projects

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Definition

- There are many definitions

- A project is a resource bound process to achieve benefits through a pre-defined, preferred outcome, constrained by time, cost, quality and scope.

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Why Projects?

- An organisation may have an issue that needs to be resolved
- A project is set up to resolve the issue
- In the end, we are looking to get the **benefits** from the project
- Not part of Business as Usual – this is a **temporary** structure
  - The benefit(s) turn into Business As Usual (BAU)
  - The project structure closes

Process compared with Project Management

Process

1. Repeat process or product
2. Several objectives
3. Ongoing
4. People are consistent or same
5. Systems in place to integrate efforts
6. Performance, cost, & time known
7. Part of the line organisation
8. Supports of established practice
9. Supports current situation

Project

1. New process or product
2. One objective
3. One shot – limited life
4. More heterogeneous (diverse)
5. Systems must be created to integrate efforts
6. Performance, cost & time less certain
7. Outside of line organisation
8. Interrupts established practice
9. Changes current situation

Derived from Pinto, J. (2012) Project Management: Achieving Competitive Advantage, 3rd Edition, Prentice Hall

Project vs. Process Work

Project

- Take place outside the process world
- Unique and separate from normal organisation work
- Continually evolving

Process

- Ongoing, day-to-day activities
- Use existing systems, properties, and capabilities
- Typically repetitive

A project is a temporary endeavor undertaken to create a unique product or service. PMBoK 2000

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Where do projects come from?

- Projects can come from anywhere
  - Internal Stakeholders
  - Customers

    (more than half of innovative ideas originate from customers (Goffin and Mitchell, 2010)
  - External Stakeholders
  - Legislation
  - Innovation
  - Business Problems

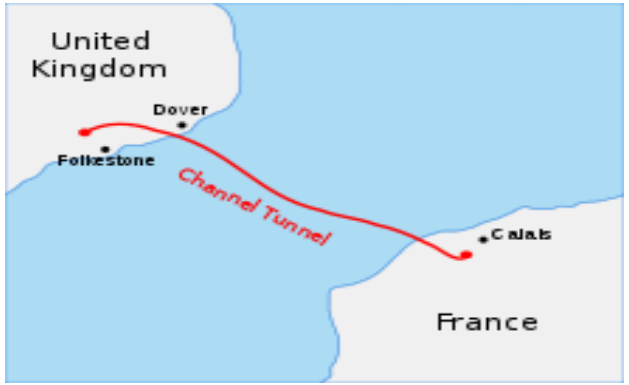
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What kind of projects are there

- Projects are hugely varied
- They are undertaken in all parts of government, industry and commerce
- They seek to achieve different benefits
- They have different lifecycles
- There is a core body of knowledge, but then projects become specialised to different fields of endeavour
- Generally, the following is a good overview of the project management process

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Examples of projects



- Channel Tunnel (Chunnel) between England and France
  - 1988 started and ended in 1994
  - Two national government, bankers, contractors and several regulatory agencies

- Introduce Windows Vista
  - Vista is an operating system released in several variations by Microsoft for use on personal computers, including home and business desktops, laptops, tablet PCs, and media center PCs.

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Examples of projects

- Some people argue that building the Egyptian pyramids was a project, as was building the Great Wall of China
- Most people consider the Manhattan Project to be the first project to use “modern” project management
- Split the atom (Manhattan project 1942 – nuclear weapon, Atomic Bomb)
  - United States with the United Kingdom and Canada that produced the first atomic bomb during World War II